

71.2 COLLECTIVE NOUNS

Collective nouns have a singular form, but refer to a number of people or objects as a group. In US English they generally take a singular verb. In UK English they can often be used with either singular or plural verbs.



If the subject describes a singular body, then the verb form must be singular.

The **team** **is** getting a new manager next year.

[The team as a whole is getting a new manager.]

Subject describes a collection of individuals.

UK only.

The **team** **are** feeling excited about the news.

[Each individual member of the team is feeling excited.]

FURTHER EXAMPLES

The **society** **is** going to have a meeting next week.



The **society** **are** discussing how often they should meet.

The **band** **has** just released its new album.



The **band** **have** been on tour to promote their new album.

The **government** **is** located in the capital city.



The **government** **are** in talks with the US.

My **family** **is** bigger than most other families I know.



My **family** **are** going away together for the first time in years.

The **company** **has** hired some new staff.



The **company** **have** been busy baking for a charity cake sale.